
BTC / USD
$1,000
27 NOV 2013

FOUR FIGURES

018 / 27 NOV 2013 / BITCOIN / COMMON

A BULL TAKES ITS FIRST STEPS.

A young bull stands beside a wooden gate, his white blaze bright in the morning light. The valley stretches behind him, quiet and open. On the sign beside the path, bitcoin has acquired a fourth digit.

On 27 November 2013, bitcoin reached $1,000 on Mt. Gox in a price quoted directly in US dollars. The venue mattered: BTC China had crossed the equivalent value in yuan on 19 November, while other exchanges still quoted lower prices. The Mt. Gox crossing gave the emerging currency a headline that travelled far beyond its usual audience.

The price had doubled in a week. In WIRED's report that day, market-data entrepreneur Dan Held described friends and acquaintances changing their questions. People who had wanted Bitcoin explained were now asking how to acquire it. Four figures brought excitement, curiosity and a growing sense that this experiment might become something much larger.

Here, that early confidence takes the form of a young bull finding his feet. His chestnut coat, white forehead blaze and single white foreleg are worth remembering. Eleven years later, on card 095, the same bull will return to this valley fully grown, with a herd behind him and two more digits on the sign.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 The four-figure marker

BTC / USD, $1,000 and 27 NOV 2013 anchor the scene to the Mt. Gox dollar milestone.

02 A face to remember

The white forehead blaze, chestnut coat and single white foreleg identify the bull who returns fully grown on card 095.

03 Small horns, first steps

The small horns and tentative stance suit a young bull finding his feet beside an early price milestone.

04 The returning valley

Look for the spreading tree, mountain ridge and wooden fence. They reappear in Six Figures, joining the two scenes across eleven years.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: CoinDesk, 27 November 2013; WIRED, 27 November 2013. The bull, valley and sign are symbolic artwork, not a documented scene. The young animal represents early market confidence, not Bitcoin's creation. The line on the sign is illustrative, not a price chart or forecast. The paired captions are editorial, not quotations.